Brandon Miner

San Francisco, CA
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Public Technologist — Data systems for civil liberties, government accountability, and privacy advocacy

Education

University of San Francisco — **San Francisco, CA**
M.S. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence — *Jul 2025 – Jun 2026*

San Diego State University — **San Diego, CA**
B.S. in Statistics with Emphasis in Data Science, Minor in Mathematics — *Aug 2022 – Dec 2025*

Experience

Data Scientist — San Francisco, CA
ACLU — *Oct 2025 – Jun 2026*

- Followed agile development methodologies to create an end-to-end ML video auditing platform (**Python, FastAPI, MySQL, Docker**) to automate settlement requirements review of police bodycam footage, projected to eliminate **300+ hours** of manual review per monthly cycle and expand oversight capacity to amplify the criminal justice system.
- Developing a GPU-accelerated ETL pipeline using **FFmpeg** and **Whisper**-based speech-to-text to ingest, transcribe, and process **600+ police videos per month**, with **LLM-driven auto-labeling** to flag potential rights violations and misconduct patterns for legal review.
- Delivering the full auditing system to non-technical legal and advocacy staff via a **private-server FastAPI backend** and **React.js** web frontend, ensuring sensitive footage remains secure and off commercial infrastructure.
- Leading a **geospatial privacy analysis** initiative to expose deanonymization risks in commercially sold location data, directly informing advocacy efforts for legislative bans on data broker practices.
- Engineered a spatial data pipeline using **Plotly**, OpenStreetMap, and the **Google Reverse Geocoding API** to translate raw GPS coordinates into identifiable behavioral patterns, applying **DBSCAN clustering** to detect sensitive personal locations (home, work, medical facilities) from purportedly anonymized data, producing concrete evidentiary exhibits for policy arguments.

Data Scientist, Lead Intern — San Diego, CA
San Diego County Taxpayers Association — *Mar 2024 – Aug 2025*

- Learned team leadership through statistical analysis initiatives I led across collaborative civic policy research, managing a team of **4+ associates** to deliver quantitative analysis on public workforce, government spending, and homelessness programs for public reporting.
- Built a public workforce analytics pipeline using iterative **web scraping** and **NLP-based standardization** to analyze wage dynamics, identifying significant taxpayer cost of **19.7%** police wage increase per **1%** staffing drop).
- Analyzed regional homelessness expenditure using **mixed-effects models** and **multicollinearity reduction** to evaluate program efficacy, identifying high-impact interventions like rapid rehousing to guide future public resource allocation.

Technical Projects

California Grape ETL Pipeline & Dashboard

- **Engineered a multi-source ETL pipeline** in Python to extract, transform, and consolidate disparate agricultural datasets into a unified schema, making government-held data accessible for public analysis.
- **Containerized and deployed a technical delivery** via Docker Compose and **Google Cloud Run**, ensuring reliable public access to a **live interactive Streamlit dashboard** for data visualization of regional production data.

Credit Card Fraud Detection

- Built a binary classification model using **Logistic Regression (Scikit-Learn)** to identify fraudulent transactions on a highly imbalanced dataset.

Technical Skills

Programming & Tools: Python (Pandas, PyTorch, FastAPI, Streamlit, Plotly), SQL (PostgreSQL), R, Bash
Civic & Public-Interest Tech: government data pipelines, web scraping, geospatial analysis (DBSCAN, OpenStreetMap), privacy/deanonymization analysis, public dashboards
ML & NLP: multi-stage text classification, LLM-assisted labeling, mixed-effects regression, statistical reporting
Deployment & Security: private-server deployment, Docker, secure off-commercial-cloud delivery, stakeholder communication with legal/advocacy teams